

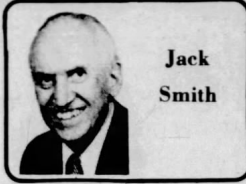
AS FREMONT TRIBUNE, Mon., July 30, 1979

Baseball coach, 74, 'unretires' for second time

When I retired in El Paso a couple of years ago, I was interested to see the name Andy Cohen on the sports page as coach of the local university baseball nine, the Miners.

Could this possibly be the same Andy Cohen who was one of my boyhood heroes as second baseman for the Minneapolis Millers of the American Association (long before the major-league Twins) — a team that won the city's first pennant in years and met the Newark Bears in the Little World Series?

Could this be the same Andy Cohen whose community involvement and winning personality made him a civic hero as well? Those were the days of



Jack
Smith

the stock theatrical companies in the outlying cities, and the Bainbridge Players of the Minneapolis Shubert set box-office records when they signed Andy Cohen to play the Joe E. Brown role in the baseball comedy, "Elmer the Great."

Well, it was — and is — the same Andy Cohen, and last fall I met him for the first time at a meeting of the Touchdown Club, where he is a regular and is frequently called upon to deliver one of his witty-but-reverent invocations.

Although Andy played three seasons with the old New York Giants in the Polo Grounds, you're more likely to remember him if you lived close to a minor-league team. In addition to his nine years in Minneapolis, Andy played on a pennant winner in Buffalo and either played or coached at Dayton; Denver; New Orleans; Indianapolis; Elmira, N.Y.; Pine Bluff, Ark.; Eau Claire, Wis.; Waco, Tex., and El Paso, where he grew up and was a three-letter man in

voted into the city's own Sports Hall of Fame.

A good family life is a key to a happy, active senior life, too, says Andy. His wife, Barbara, "who may be the only Van Duzer ever to change her name to Cohen," is Andy's "good-health secret," he admits. He credits her with his good eating habits and proper work-rest regimen. His children all live nearby and are a comfort to him. One daughter, Kathi Jensen, manages the retail liquor establishment he owns; another

daughter, Marina Nickerson, is an advertising account executive who also writes theater reviews for The El Paso Times; and his son, Henry, a recent university graduate, is in Dallas, launching a drama career.

"An older person should never think of himself as useless," Andy says. "I get up every morning, look at the sunrise, and am thankful for another day and the opportunities it will bring to use what I know, what I can do, and what I have experienced." The formula seems to work.

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